

Conservation Leadership Programme: Progress Report

01311021: Conservation of the Endangered Preuss's Monkey (*Allochrocebus preussi*) on the Obudu Plateau, Nigeria



Host Country: **Nigeria**

Site Location: **Obudu Plateau, Cross River State**

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Date: 12th December, 2022



Section 1:

Background

The population of the Endangered Preuss's monkey (*Allochrocebus preussi*) on Nigeria's Obudu Plateau is assumed to be declining due to increasing habitat loss, bushmeat hunting and actions by farmers to prevent crop-raiding. This project aims to provide accurate information on the population status, threat factors and remaining suitable habitat for the Preuss's monkey on the Plateau. We aim to use this knowledge to facilitate the development of a species-specific conservation action plan for Preuss's monkey on the Obudu Plateau, and conservation-orientated management plan for the Obudu Plateau to aid population recovery of the species.

Section 2:

Summary of Objectives, Activities and Outputs

Objective 1: Quantify the threats posed by local hunters and farmers on Preuss's monkey		
Activities	Outputs	Forthcoming activities planned
Hunter/farmer questionnaire and informal interview was conducted in six communities (Okpazange, Apambu, Old Ikwette, Anape, Keyi and Kegol) on the Obudu Plateau.	Identification of the different forest patches utilized by the communities. Identification of areas where Preuss's monkey have been sighted recently and in the last 20years. Other primates mentioned to have been sighted by respondents include; Tantalus monkey (<i>Chlorocebus tantalus</i>), Putty-nosed monkey (<i>Cercopithecus nictitans</i>), Mona monkey (<i>Cercopithecus mona</i>) and Baboon (<i>Papio anubis</i>). Identification of the nature and extent of threats posed to Preuss's monkey and other primates on the Obudu plateau by farmers and hunters. Majority of the respondents reported a decline in the population of Preuss's monkey in the last 20 years.	Survey of local markets and bars where bushmeat is suspected to be sold. The type and quantity of bushmeat especially of monkeys will be investigated.

	Majority of the hunters agreed that they hunted all monkey species on the Obudu plateau, including Preuss's monkey although they claimed not to eat "black monkeys" (Preuss's monkey and Putty-nosed monkey) due to cultural and historical reasons, but still hunt them for sale.	
Objective 2: Determine the remaining suitable habitat for Preuss's monkey on the Obudu Plateau		
Activities	Outputs	Forthcoming activities planned
Identification of forest patches with recent sightings of Preuss's monkey elicited during the informal interview with hunters and farmers. The team also scanned some of these forest patches for the presence of Preuss's monkey.	The forest patches identified to be surveyed are; Okpazange, Ogolo 1 & 2, Monkey face view, Mile 2, Otondo, Afunda, Mete, Onyeng (Rotest), Onimba, Osuolor, Megbi/Avese, Mage, Achaga, Apambu, Otaliga waterfall, Anape community forest 1 & 2 and Afundu valley. The team sighted four individuals of Preuss's monkey on the Ogolo 2 forest patch of the Obudu plateau.	Reconnaissance survey and ground-truthing of these forest patches. Mapping of forest patches identified using satellite imagery and remote sensing. The sizes of the forest patches will be estimated and suitable habitat for Preuss's monkey predicted.

Objective 3: Determine the abundance and distribution of Preuss's monkey on the Obudu plateau		
Activities	Outputs	Forthcoming activities planned
Ordering of equipment to be used for this exercise.	Expecting all equipment to be available before the end of December, 2022. 90% of the equipment ordered has been delivered.	A recce survey in combination with direct searches will be carried out in the identified forest patches. Placement and monitoring of camera traps in the forest patches.
Objective 4: Develop a conservation action plan for Preuss's monkey and a conservation management plan for the Obudu Plateau		
Activities	Outputs	Forthcoming activities planned
A visit to six communities around the Obudu Plateau.	Identification of key stakeholders, community chiefs and youth leaders in the six communities visited. Establishing contact with schools to be visited for conservation awareness	1. Visit to schools in these communities to raise conservation awareness for Preuss's monkey. 2. Engage the community leaders and other stakeholders on the need and importance of conservation of the Preuss's monkey and other primate species on the Obudu Plateau. 3. Meetings with regulators, policy makers and NGO's.

Section 3:

Summary of key project outcomes to date

A total of 152 questionnaire interviews were conducted in six Obudu Plateau communities (Okpazange, Old Ikwette, Apambu, Anape, Keyi and Kegol) between October 20th and November 30th 2022 to elicit information on the current status and threats posed to the Preuss's monkey by human activities on the plateau. This survey confirmed the existence of Preuss's monkey although the species was reported to be rarely encountered. The identified forest patches by hunters to have recently sighted the species are; Mage, Ogolo, Afundu, Mete, Megbi, Achaga, and Emale. Our ground survey found that some of these forest patches have been severely degraded and others almost completely turned into farmlands. We sighted a group of four adult Preuss's monkey on the Ogolo 2 forest patch of the plateau on one occasion. The interviewees stated a reduction in the number of Preuss's monkey and other fauna species on the plateau as they saw fewer of these animals now than 20 years ago. Although all the farmers interviewed complained of crop raiding by primates (Tantalus, Mona, Putty-nosed and in rare cases Baboon), Preuss's monkey was not part as they were rarely seen on the farms. Farmers took drastic measures against primates raiding their crops such as shooting, trapping and even poisoning, although some claimed to only chase them when they are sighted on farmlands.

The hunters stated that they hunt all fauna species on the plateau including primates. Even though they claimed not to consume "black monkeys" (Preuss's monkey and Putty nose) they were however not spared.

Problems encountered to Date

Project timetable and costs

The initial start date of March, 2020 for the project was delayed due to the COVID-19 pandemic. Due to this unavoidable delay and a global “cost of living” crisis caused by the war in Ukraine, cost projections in the initial project budget were no longer realistic when fieldwork began in October, 2022. This is significantly affecting the costs of local travel and the purchase of supplies and equipment.

Team

The project was additionally delayed due to medical conditions experienced by one of our team members. Combined with the impact of the pandemic, this meant that the project commenced 1½ -years behind the expected start date. This caused one key team member to withdraw in July 2022 due to her need to commence her PhD in the UK. We then had to bring on a team member at short notice to enable us start the project in October, 2022.

Section 4:

Table 1: Communities on the Obudu Plateau visited during the survey

S/N	Communities	Coordinates (dms)	Elevation (m)
1.	Okpazange	N06° 22. 735' E 009° 25. 257'	1,554
2.	Apambu	N06° 20. 031' E 009° 25. 609'	1,001
3.	Anape	N06° 25. 267' E 009° 21. 625'	1,558
4.	Old Ikwette	N06° 23. 926' E 009° 24. 376'	741
5.	Keyi	N06° 22. 194' E 009° 21. 123'	1,430
6.	Kegol	N06° 21. 382' E 009° 22. 770'	1,550

Table 2: Socio-demographic characteristics of respondents

Characteristics	Category	Okpazange n/% frequency	Old Ikwette n/% frequency	Kegol n/% frequency	Keyi n/% frequency	Anape n/% frequency	Apambu n/% frequency	Total
Gender	Male	10 (37.0)	19 (61.3)	11 (44.0)	15 (57.7)	24 (96.0)	16 (88.9)	95 (62.5)
	Female	17 (63.0)	12 (38.7)	14 (56.0)	11 (42.3)	1 (4.0)	2 (11.1)	57 (37.5)
	Total	27	31	25	26	25	18	152
Age	Less than 20years	0	1 (3.2)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	1 (0.7)
	20-30 years	4 (18.5)	5 (16.1)	2 (8.0)	3 (11.5)	3 (12.0)	7 (38.0)	24 (15.9)
	31-40 years	5 (14.81)	15 (48.4)	12 (48.0)	10 (38.0)	6 (24.0)	4 (22.2)	52 (34.2)
	Above 40 years	18 (66.7)	10 (32.3)	11 (44.0)	13 (50.0)	16 (64.0)	7 (38.9)	75 (49.3)
	Total	27	31	25	26	25	18	152
Education	Primary	3 (11.1)	15 (48.4)	5 (20.0)	8 (30.0)	9 (36.0)	8 (44.0)	48 (31.6)
	SSCE	7 (25.9)	3(9.7)	3 (12.0)	3 (11.5)	5 (20.0)	0 (0.0)	21 (13.8)
	NCE	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	1 (3.8)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	1 (0.7)
	Informal	17 (63.0)	13(41.93)	17(68)	14 (53.8)	11 (44)	10 (55.6)	82 (53.9)
	Total	27	31	25	26	25	18	152
Occupation	Farming	17 (63.0)	14 (45.2)	15 (60.0)	12 (46.0)	4 (16.0)	6 (33.3)	68 (44.7)
	Hunting	6 (22.2)	2 (6.5)	1 (4.0)	3 (11.53.0)	4 (16.0)	2 (11.1)	18 (11.8)
	Farming & Hunting	4 (14.8)	15 (48.4)	9 (36.0)	11 (42.3)	17 (68.0)	10 (55.6)	66 (43.4)
	Total	27	31	25	26	25	18	152
Occupational Experience	0-5yrs	1 (3.7)	3 (9.67)	3 (12.0)	1 (3.84)	0 (0.0)	1(5.55)	9 (5.9)
	6-10yrs	6 (22.2)	1 (3.2)	6 (24.0)	3 (11.5)	3 (12.0)	5(27.7)	24 (15.8)
	11-15yrs	4 (14.8)	4 (12.9)	1 (4.0)	4 (15.4)	1 (4.0)	3(16.66)	17 (11.2)
	16-20yrs	3 (11.1)	4 (12.9)	2 (8.0)	8 (30.8)	0 (0.0)	6(33.33)	23 (15.1)
	Above 20yrs	13 (48.1)	19 (61.3)	13 (52.0)	10 (38.5)	21 (84.0)	3(16.66)	79 (52.0)
	Total	27	31	25	26	25	18	152

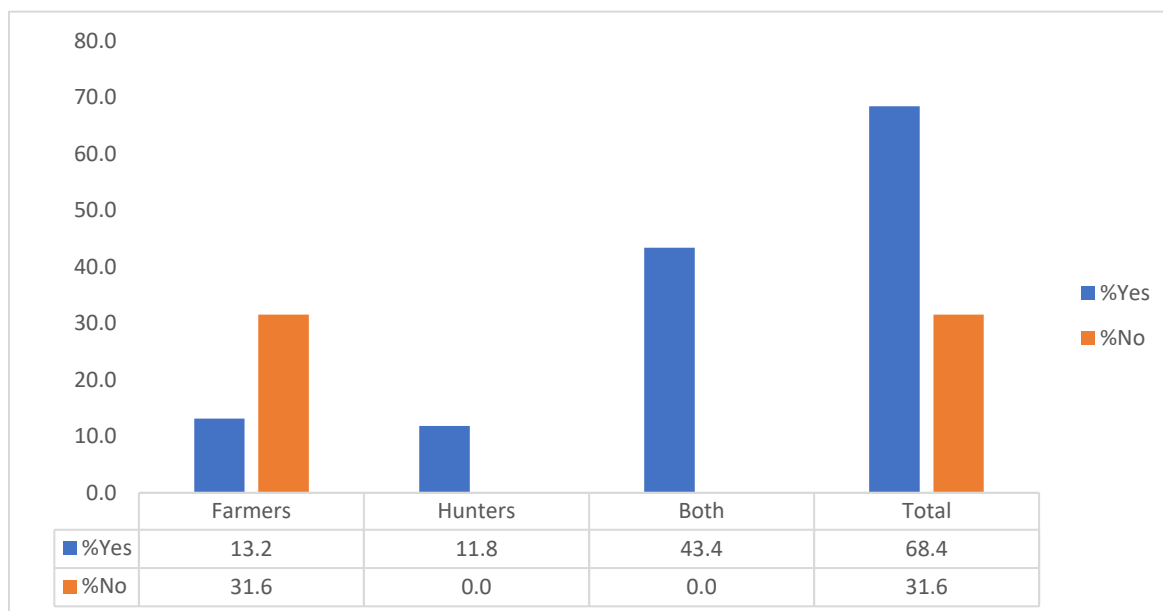


Figure 1: Respondents knowledge of Preuss's monkey

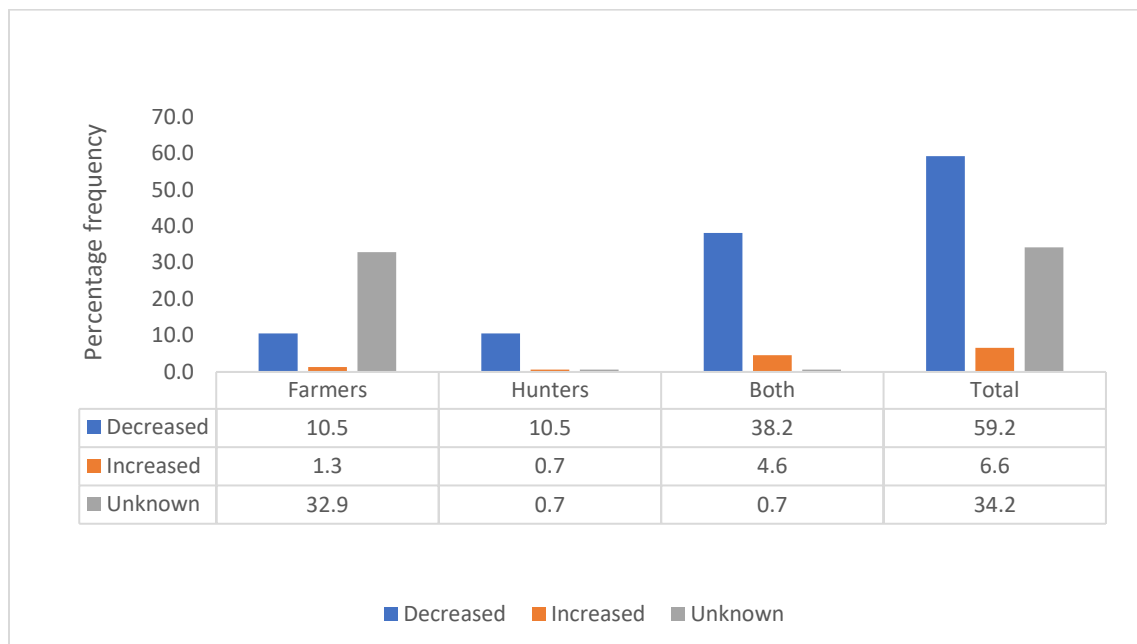


Figure 2: Perception of respondents on the status of the Preuss's monkey on the plateau in the last 20years

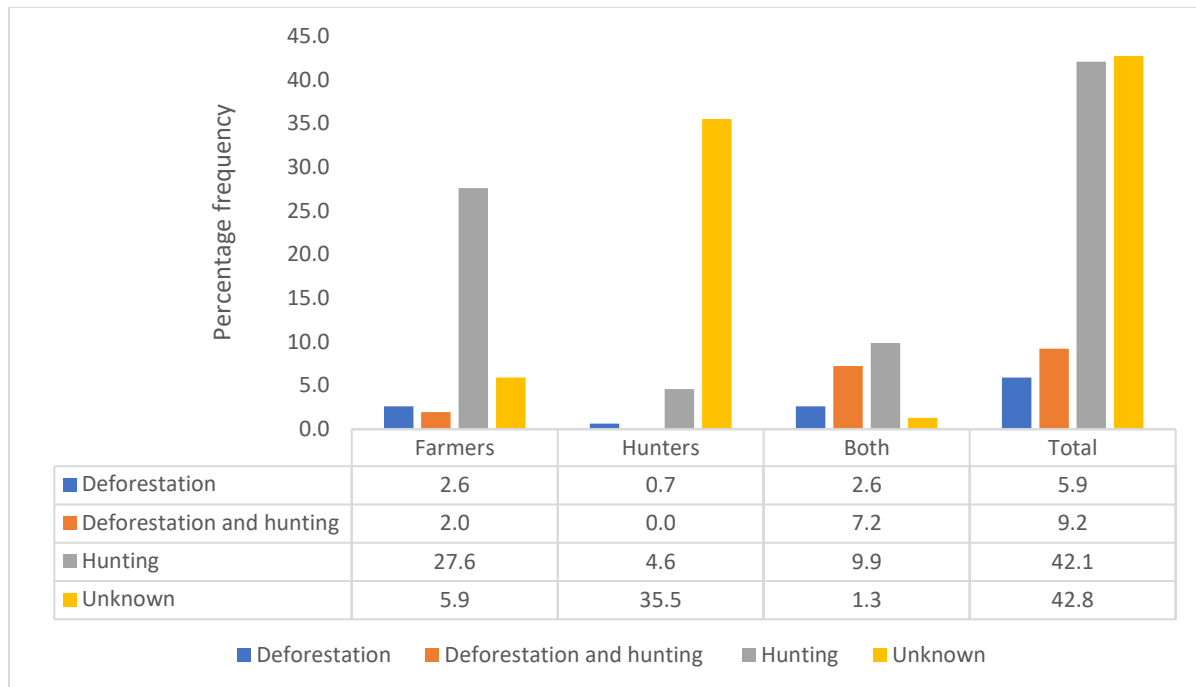


Figure 3: Respondents perception on the causes of Preuss's monkey population decline on the plateau

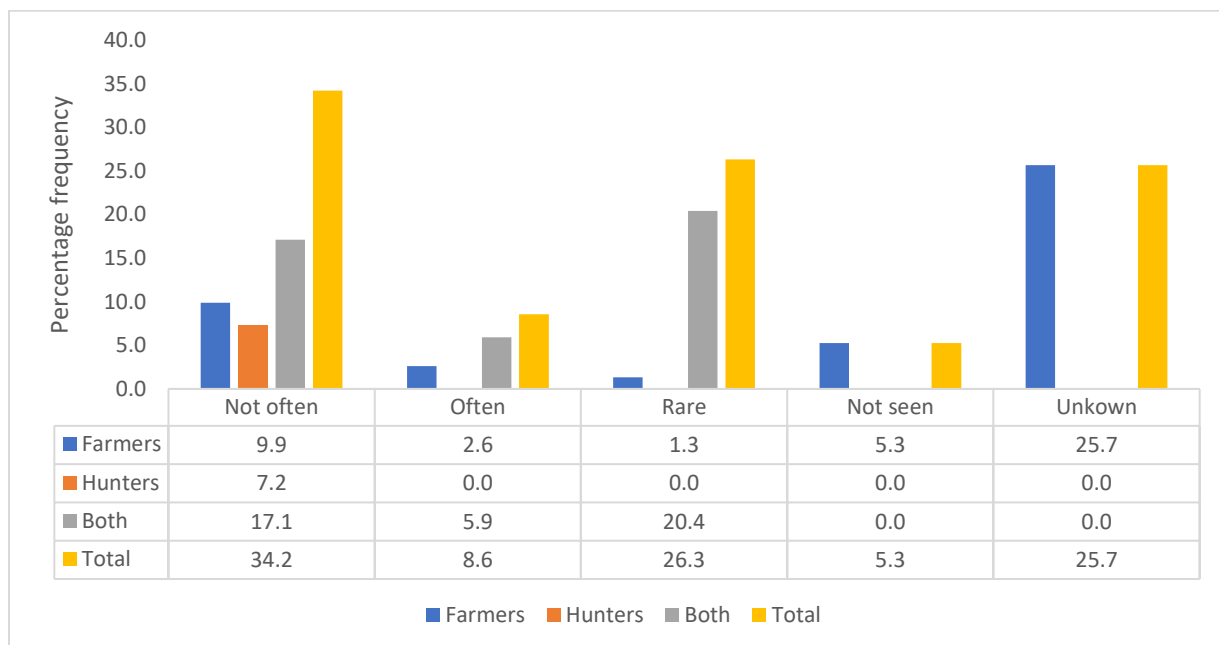


Figure 4: Frequency of sighting/observation of Preuss's monkey by respondents

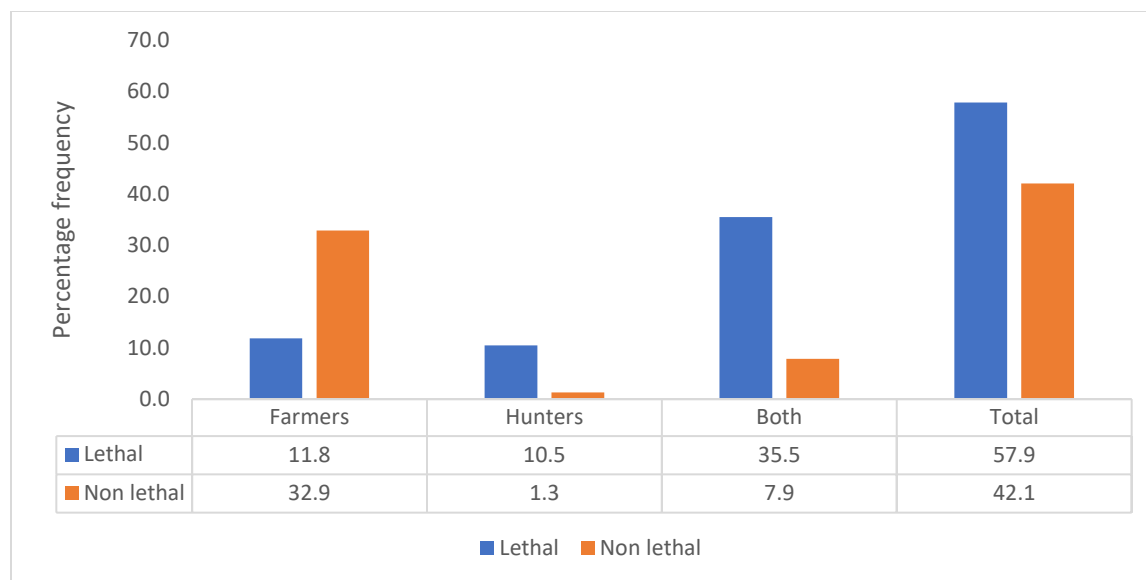


Figure 5: Measures taken to control the activities of monkeys on farms/community?

Key: Lethal=Shooting, Stoning, Trapping and Poisoning; Non-lethal=Chasing, Shouting

Photographs with leaders and members of local communities visited during the survey



Apambu community



Okpazange community



Anape community



Old Ikwette community



Keyi community



Kegol community